



Lend a Hand

2024

November 13- December 20, 2024

PERPETUALISTA

THE COMMUNITY OUTREACH DEPARTMENT ANNUAL REPORT

Lend A Hand: *Embracing the True Spirit of Christmas*



Every Christmas tells a story—of hope, of love, and of giving. And at the University of Perpetual Help System Laguna, that story continues to be written through the hearts and hands of its volunteers. On December 20, 2024, the Community Outreach Department (COD), in collaboration with the Perpetualite Nation Builders (PNB), proudly hosted the annual Lend A Hand program—one of the longest-standing outreach efforts of the university. This year's theme, “Embracing the True Spirit of Christmas,” captured the essence of what the season is all about: selfless service, meaningful connection, and unwavering generosity.



Held at the UPHSL BED Mini Gym, the event gathered students, faculty, staff, and volunteers from various departments and organizations, all driven by a shared mission—to bring Christmas closer to the hearts and homes of the underprivileged families in the university's adopted communities. Now running for more than 15 years, Lend A Hand is not just a tradition—it is a legacy of kindness that continues to evolve with every Perpetualite generation.

This year's initiative saw hundreds of Noche Buena packages prepared and distributed, filled with essential holiday goods such as pasta, sauce, canned goods, rice, and sweet treats—meant to complete the families' Christmas table. What makes this program exceptional is the collaborative spirit behind it. The packages were lovingly sponsored and put together by the university's colleges, administrative offices, support service departments, and generous partner organizations, proving that when many hands come together, greater impact is made.

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Beyond material donations, the presence of the volunteers—their smiles, their assistance, and their warm conversations—became the true gift. These acts of service showed that giving is not measured by how much, but by how deeply we care.



Volunteers: The Heart of the Program

The event was led and enlivened by the Perpetualite Nation Builders, student-volunteers who exemplify the Perpetualite commitment to service and faith. Alongside them were dedicated representatives from the COD and other volunteers from the College of Maritime Education, Psychology Society, and more. These students, many of whom were experiencing their first Lend A Hand event, expressed gratitude for the opportunity to give back and described the experience as both humbling and inspiring.



According to the Community Outreach Department, the event not only uplifts the community, but also molds the student-volunteers to become compassionate leaders—helpers of God who live by the values of service, humility, and unity.

The University of Perpetual Help System Laguna continues to champion its mission of forming individuals who are not only academically excellent, but also socially responsible and spiritually grounded. Through initiatives like Lend A Hand, Perpetualites are reminded that success is not just about personal achievement, but about lifting others along the way.

